

The Ethical Hacker's Command Handbook

Chapter 3 – Part 2: Advanced Searchsploit

Searching & Filters

Good researchers don't search more—they search smarter.

Learning Objectives

Learn exact phrase searches, title-only searches, multiple keywords, exclusion filters, version-based searches, CVE lookups, and efficient exploit research workflows.

searchsploit "Apache 2.4.49"

Purpose: Exact phrase search

What it does: Searches for an exact product/version.

When to use: Known software version.

Avoid when: Version unknown.

Memory Tip: Quotes = Exact

searchsploit apache linux

Purpose: Multiple keywords

What it does: Narrows results using multiple terms.

When to use: Reducing broad result sets.

Avoid when: Single keyword is sufficient.

Memory Tip: Combine related terms

searchsploit -t apache

Purpose: Title-only search

What it does: Searches only exploit titles.

When to use: Finding exploits by product name.

Avoid when: Searching descriptions is needed.

Memory Tip: t = Title

searchsploit --case Apache

Purpose: Case-sensitive search

What it does: Matches exact capitalization.

When to use: Specific text matching.

Avoid when: General searches.

Memory Tip: Case matters

searchsploit apache --exclude="dos"

Purpose: Exclude results

What it does: Filters unwanted result categories.

When to use: Removing irrelevant DoS entries.

Avoid when: All results are useful.

Memory Tip: Exclude = Filter

searchsploit windows

Purpose: Platform search

What it does: Searches by operating system/platform.

When to use: After OS detection.

Avoid when: Application-specific searches.

Memory Tip: Platform-based research

searchsploit CVE-2021-41773

Purpose: CVE search

What it does: Finds entries matching a CVE.

When to use: Known vulnerability identifier.

Avoid when: CVE unknown.

Memory Tip: CVE = Specific issue

Research Workflow

Nmap → Identify Product → Identify Version → Exact Search → Apply Filters → Review
References → Verify Applicability → Document Findings

Goal	Command
Basic search	searchsploit apache
Exact phrase	searchsploit "Apache 2.4.49"
Title only	searchsploit -t apache
Multiple keywords	searchsploit apache linux
Exclude results	searchsploit apache --exclude="dos"
Search CVE	searchsploit CVE-2021-41773
Platform	searchsploit windows

Practice Questions

1. Why use quotation marks in Searchsploit?
2. What does -t do?
3. Why search using software versions?

4. How does --exclude help?
5. Why should Searchsploit results always be verified?